

Ganga Rajpoot, 35

Bhoyra, Chhatarpur, Madhya Pradesh

What makes her a water warrior: Ganga Rajpoot defied superstition and led the revival of Baba Talaab, a 12-acre historic pond, securing water for Bhoyra village. For decades, villagers feared restoring the dried-up pond, believing it cursed, while its land was lost to farming. Undeterred, she formed a "**Jal Saheli**" group of 25 women, mobilizing them to desilt and rebuild the pond. When the rains came, the pond filled, replenishing groundwater and enabling irrigation. Expanding her mission, she rejuvenated six more water bodies and spearheaded river basin restoration, proving that breaking myths can reshape realities and secure water for generations.

Parvati Devi, 53

Jarga, Koderma, Jharkhand

What makes her a water warrior: For eight years, Parvati Devi transformed Jarga village, Jharkhand, from a parched land to a thriving oasis. As a Panchayat Samiti member, she tackled erratic rainfall and migration by leading **large-scale afforestation** and water conservation efforts. She planted 450 trees, built six ponds, 675 recharge structures, and a water tower, restoring the village's water security. Her work revived farming, slowed migration, and even improved rainfall. More than just infrastructure, she reimagined an entire landscape, proving that one woman's vision can turn drought into abundance and water into a promise of prosperity.





Dharmo Devi, 49

Dhaula Kuan, Paonta Sahib, Sirmaur, Himachal Pradesh

What makes her a water warrior: In Paonta Sahib, Himachal Pradesh, Dharmo Devi led a watershed revival, constructing 975 trenches, 208 recharge ponds, and 23 check dams, replenishing 109 million litres of groundwater. As ***Adhyaksh*** **of the Forest Development Committee**, she mobilized her community while balancing motherhood and farming. With support from Himmotthan Society, she transformed barren land into a thriving ecosystem, raising water tables and reviving springs. Once drought-prone, her village now thrives with reliable water access. Dharmo Devi's leadership proves that true change begins when individuals take responsibility, making her a beacon of grassroots conservation.